

PAIN AND DISCOMFORT: PATIENT MANAGEMENT GUIDELINES

Name:	Job Number:	Rating:
Unit:	Job Title:	
Contract Date:		
Evaluation Key: M- Met NM- Not Met NA- Not Applicable		Method of Evaluation: Knowledge: Exam(Written/Oral) Skills: Demonstration/Discussion Attitude: Observation
Rating Scale: Met: 90% - 100% Not Met: 89% & below and remedial once NA-(Not applicable) – entries to be deducted from the total score		

Note: Knowledge item 13 in the source prints "for 224 hours"; transcribed as "24 hours" to match the identical wording in Skills item 9 on the same form.

COMPETENCIES		EVALUATOR ASSESSMENT		
		M (1)	NM (0)	NA
I.	KNOWLEDGE			
1.	Explain why it is important for a nurse to accept that pain is what the patient says it is, and exist when he/ she says it does.			
2.	Discuss the rationale for the World Health Organization making the recommendation that pain is the fifth vital signs.			
3.	Explain why it is important for a nurse to pay special attention to Vulnerable Patients when their inability to communicate verbally does not negate the possibility that an individual is experiencing pain and is in need of appropriate pain relieving treatment.			
4.	Describe what acute pain is i.e. it has a sudden onset and commonly reduces over the short period of time (days, hours, minutes) and often follows injury to the body and generally disappears when the injury heals.			
5.	Describe the objective physical signs associated with acute pain e.g. tachycardia, hypertension, diaphoresis, mydriasis (dilation of the pupil) and pallor.			
6.	Describe the chronic pain is i.e. pain which persists a month beyond the usual course of an acute disease or a reasonable time for an injury to heal, or that is associated with a chronic pathologic process that causes continuous pain or the pain recurs at intervals for month or years.			
7.	Describe procedural pain i.e. pain and/ or discomfort from diagnostic or therapeutic procedures, such as lumbar puncture, wound and burn debridement etc.			
8.	Describe discomfort i.e. mental or physical uneasiness, including nausea, which occurs as a result of acute or chronic conditions, diagnostic or therapeutic procedures or anticipation of them, or as side effects of analgesia.			
9.	Explain how to complete a full pain assessment i.e. • Pain intensity • Location • Duration • Character • Frequency • Pain score • Pain relief taken and effect For vulnerable or patients unable to communicate verbally use the appropriate objective Pain assessment tool (modified FLACC and FRAAC) 1. Adult patient is 14 years and older 2. Pediatric – patient is younger than 14 3. Neonate – patient younger than 40 weeks corrected gestational age, plus 28 days			
10.	State the various measures for pain control i.e. pharmacological and non-pharmacological.			
11.	Describe the elements of Pain management that patient need to be educated about when it is part of the treatment, such as: • Understanding Pain and other symptoms • The risk of Pain and other symptoms • The importance of effective pain and symptom management • The assessment process for pain and symptoms • Methods for managing Pain and other symptoms			

COMPETENCIES		EVALUATOR ASSESSMENT		
		M (1)	NM (0)	NA
12.	Explain how often a full pain assessment needs to be done i.e. • In- patients at least every shift • Out-patients at every encounter • Patients in labor, on admission, at least to understand if their pain is typical or atypical of an individual in labor and if there are other pain sites unrelated to the labor and delivery process			
13.	Discuss the requirements for reassessment of pain i.e. • Patients with a pain score ≤ 2 or 2.5 in neonates for 24 hours should be reassessed for every shift • Patients with pain score of 2 or more are reassessed every 4 hours • 30-60 minutes after an implementation of an intervention for pain or more frequently as required • Patients receiving IV pain medication with titrated dose ranges will be reassessed and documented every 10-15 minutes until the pain is relieved • Reassessment must include frequency, duration, character, location and intensity of pain e.g. for women in labor – the frequency of contractions, the duration of the contractions and the pain score			
14.	Explain how to document pain assessment and reassessment in the patient forms and notes according to area of practice.			
II.	SKILLS			
1.	Demonstrate how to assess and reassess pain the vulnerable patients when their inability to communicate verbally does not negate the possibility that an individual is experiencing pain and is in need of appropriate pain relieving treatment.			
2.	Show how a patient has acute pain is i.e. it has sudden onset and commonly reduces over a short period of time (days, hours, minutes) and often follows injury to the body and generally disappears when the injury heals.			
3.	Demonstrates how to assess the objective physical signs associated with acute pain e.g. tachycardia, hypertension, diaphoresis, mydriasis (dilation of the pupil) and pallor.			
4.	Show how a patient has chronic pain is i.e Pain which persists a month beyond the usual course of an acute disease or a reasonable time for an injury to heal, or that associated with a chronic pathologic process that causes continuous pain or the pain recurs at intervals for months or years.			
5.	Show how a patient has procedural pain i.e. pain and/or discomfort from diagnostic or therapeutic procedures, such as lumbar puncture wound and burn debridement etc.			
6.	Show how a patient has discomfort i.e. mental or physical uneasiness, including nausea, which occurs as a result of acute or chronic conditions, diagnostic or therapeutic procedures or anticipating of them, or as side effects of analgesia.			
7.	Demonstrate how to complete a full pain assessment i.e. • Pain intensity • Location • Duration • Character • Frequency • Pain Score • Pain relief taken and effect For vulnerable or patients unable to communicate verbally use the appropriate objective pain assessment tool (Modified FLACC and FRAAC) 1. Adult – patient is 14 years and older 2. Pediatric – patient is younger than 14 3. Neonate – patient younger than 40 weeks corrected gestational age, plus 28 days			
8.	Demonstrate how to complete a full pain assessment needs to be done i.e. • In-patient at least every shift • Out-patient at every encounter • Patients in labor, on admission, at least to understand if their Pain is typical or atypical of an individual in labor and if there are other pain sites unrelated to the labor and delivery process			

Formula: $\frac{\text{Raw Score} \times 100\%}{\text{Total Score}} =$ % Rating	NEEDS REMEDIAL: YES NO REMEDIAL DATE:
Evaluators Comments/Recommendations: Evaluated By: Evaluator's Name/Signature/Job Number	Staff Nurse Comments: Conformed By: Staff Name/Signature Date